DAY 34 | PRE-READ

Watching AI While It Works

A light read before Day 34. About 15 minutes, no code required.

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Why read this?

Once an AI system is live, you need to know how it is doing right now: is it fast, is it right, is it safe, is it within budget? Tomorrow you build the instruments that answer these questions.

1. A car dashboard

A car's dashboard shows speed, fuel and warning lights. You do not open the bonnet every few minutes. An AI system needs a dashboard too: how many requests, how fast, how many errors, how much it costs, and how happy users are.

2. A flight recorder

After an incident, investigators read the flight recorder to see exactly what happened. **Logs** and **traces** are the flight recorder of software: they record each request, which documents were used, which model answered and how long each step took.

Signal	Question it answers
Logs	What happened in this one request?
Metrics	How is the whole system doing?
Traces	Which step was slow?
Feedback	Are users getting good answers?

3. Warning lights that matter

A warning light that flashes all the time gets ignored. Good **alerts** fire only when something real and lasting happens, and each one tells a named person what to do.

4. Listening to users

A thumbs-down button, a user asking the same question twice, or someone asking for a human are all signals. Teams that review these signals and turn each fixed problem into a test improve week after week.

Key idea: if you cannot see it, you cannot fix it. Instrument first, then improve.

5. Think about these before class

- Which three numbers would you want on a dashboard for your capstone?
- What would a useless alert look like? What would a useful one look like?
- How could an app learn from users without asking them to fill in forms?

Ashiato (足跡): footprints, the trail left behind